

Multiple Choice

1. **Answer:** A

Options: A) Paap; B) Punya; C) Pudgala; D) Akash

Note: In Jaina traditions, "bad karma" is referred to as "paap," which signifies negative actions that lead to adverse consequences in the cycle of birth and rebirth.

2. **Answer:** A

Options: A) Divine power; B) Sexual virility; C) Military acumen; D) Philosophical intellect

Note: The numen of Augustus refers to the divine power attributed to him as a ruler, reflecting the belief in his connection to the divine and the authority that came with it in Roman religion.

3. **Answer:** A

Options: A) Disciple; B) Faithful; C) Devotee; D) Enlightened

Note: The Punjabi word "Sikh" translates to "disciple," reflecting the fundamental belief in Sikhism that followers are students of the teachings of the Guru.

4. **Answer:** B

Options: A) Trace; B) Original ground; C) Manifestation; D) True sign

Note: The term honji in Tendai Buddhism refers to the concept of "original ground," which signifies the fundamental, inherent nature of reality from which all phenomena arise.

5. **Answer:** B

Options: A) of a similar substance; B) of the same substance; C) of like substance; D) of human substance

Note: The term homoousios, derived from Greek, specifically means "of the same substance," and is crucial in Christian theology to describe the relationship of Jesus Christ to God the Father in the doctrine of the Trinity.

True / False

6. **Answer:** True

Options: A) True; B) False

Note: The Quakers, also known as the Religious Society of Friends, prioritize simplicity in worship and lifestyle, advocating for a personal and unmediated relationship with God over elaborate rituals or doctrines.

7. **Answer:** True

Options: A) True; B) False

Note: The first Buddhist temple in Japan, known as Hōryū-ji, was indeed constructed in 596 CE under the influence of Prince Shōtoku, marking the introduction of Buddhism to the country.

8. **Answer:** False

Options: A) True; B) False

Note: The statement is false because it was Augustine of Hippo, not Anselm, who was the primary theologian opposing Pelagius in the discussions about human nature and sin.

9. **Answer:** True

Options: A) True; B) False

Note: The Comunidades de Base, or Base Communities, emerged in El Salvador as grassroots movements that promoted social justice, human dignity, and solidarity, aligning with Bishop Oscar Romero's advocacy for the marginalized and his call for resistance against oppression.

10. **Answer:** True

Options: A) True; B) False

Note: During Japan's occupation of Korea, the Japanese colonial government promoted Confucianism to reinforce social order and control, making it a dominant ideology among the Korean population.

Long Form Response

11. **Answer:** The first of the Four Noble Truths in Buddhism teaches that suffering, or "dukkha," is an inherent part of human existence. This concept highlights that everyone experiences pain, loss, and dissatisfaction at various points in their lives. Recognizing suffering is significant because it encourages individuals to confront their struggles rather than ignore them, leading to a deeper understanding of themselves and their place in the world. By acknowledging suffering, Buddhists believe that people can begin to seek ways to alleviate it, ultimately aiming for a state of enlightenment and peace. This understanding fosters compassion towards oneself and others, as it emphasizes that suffering is a universal experience.

Note: correct because it emphasizes that the first Noble Truth of suffering (dukkha) serves as a foundational understanding in Buddhism, prompting individuals to face their struggles and fostering self-awareness and insight into the nature of human existence.

12. **Answer:** The Obon festival is a significant event in Japanese culture that honors the spirits of deceased family members. This three-day celebration, typically held in mid-August, involves various rituals that express gratitude and respect for ancestors. Families clean their homes and gravesites, prepare special foods, and participate in dances, known as Bon Odori, to welcome back the spirits. Lanterns are often lit to guide the spirits home, creating a sense of connection between the living and the

dead. Through these practices, Obon reinforces the importance of family ties and remembrance in Japanese society.

Note: correct because it accurately describes the Obon festival's cultural significance in Japan, detailing the rituals performed to honor deceased ancestors, such as cleaning, preparing special foods, and lighting lanterns to guide spirits home, which fosters a connection between the living and the dead.